

**Question:**  
The ratio of the electric poles and electric wires needed to connect and supply the electricity in a certain neighborhood is 1:3. If the total number of electric wires needed to connect the electricity in the neighborhood is 45, calculate the total number of electric poles required by an electric company to supply the electricity in the neighborhood.

**Reasoning + Answer:**

<think>  
The ratio of electric poles to wires is 1 : 3 .  
There are a total of 45 wires .  
Since the ratio of wires is 3 , to find the number of units of the ratio , we divide 45 by 3 :  $45 / 3 = 15$  .  
The number of poles is 1 unit in the ratio .  
So there must be 15 poles : 1 to 3 is the ratio of number of poles and electric wires .  
Therefore the number of poles required to supply electricity in a neighborhood is 15 .  
</think>  
< answer >  
15  
</answer>

